troops to pursue him. Basava was captured and executed (or, possibly, died accidentally while on the run).

The sect, however, survived. Its disciples became known as *Virasaivas*, and for centuries Virasaivas would challenge the traditional castes and classes of Hinduism.

RELIGIOUS REFORM NOTWITHSTANDING, neither kingdom lasted for long.

In 1186, Parakrama Bahu died after thirty-three gloriously successful years. A string of successors to his throne were, in fairly short order, assassinated, imprisoned, blinded, and exiled; the careful unity Parakrama had constructed fell apart again, and the island lay open to occupation and conquest once more.[14]

Bijjala's sons Someshvara and Sankama, ruling his kingdom one after the other, kept their father's dominion together a little longer. But after Sankama's death, in 1181, two more young sons of Bijjala rose to the throne; and slowly, their inexperience weakened the country beyond repair. The Western Chalukya king Somesvara IV recaptured the old capital of Kalanyi, and the Kalachuri kingdom was reabsorbed into the Western Chalukya; but its days too were numbered. In 1187, Somesvara IV was killed in battle against the former vassal kingom of the Hoysala, and within two years the Seuna and Hoysala and Kakatiya had divided the corpse of the old Chalukya dominon among themselves.[15]